

SPIRITUALITY FOR CHILDREN

TOPIC: PURPOSE OF LIFE

Q: What is the purpose of our life?

A: Most people just live and die. They don't stop and ask the question, 'Who am I and why am I here? Why did I take this human birth? Why did I come to earth?' Only human beings are capable of understanding this. Not a frog or a dog. Not a butterfly or a fly. Only a human being can understand the meaning and purpose of life. We are born, we learn, we earn, we grow old and we die. But is that all? There is a greater purpose for us on earth — to realize the Truth of who we truly are.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 1: What Is The Purpose Of Our Life?, Page 6-7

Q: Why do we just learn and earn without knowing our true goal?

A: From the time we go to school, we learn so many subjects. We are taught to be successful, to be a champion, a winner. We spend our entire life trying to be an ace and we run in this race. Before we realize it, we are adults. We build our family of children and grandchildren. But we never stop to ask — what are we all really seeking? The real goal is not success or money; it is to realize the truth about who we are and why we are here.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Preface, Page 3

Q: Is success in school or career the real purpose of life?

A: Peter's mother used to push him to always be in first position in class. But Peter himself asked the question that matters most: 'Ultimately, one day, everybody has to die. Nobody will live on this earth forever. Is our purpose just to learn, earn and then, die as a successful person? Or is there a greater purpose for us on earth?' From that day, Peter's mother stopped pushing him to attain first position. Instead, she started talking to Peter about the meaning of life.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 12: You Must Be A Winner Peter!, Page 28-29

Q: What should children learn that school does not teach?

A: When we go to school, we read so many books and learn so many subjects. But we are never taught the most important thing — Spirituality. Spirituality is the science of the Spirit and just like we learn so many sciences in school, it is important for children to learn the science of the Spirit. The Spirit or the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — is who we truly are. Unfortunately, we live and die and we don't discover 'Who am I?'

Source: Spirituality for Children, Back Cover, Page 124

Q: Why do human beings have a unique opportunity that animals don't?

A: Only human beings are capable of understanding the meaning and purpose of life. Not a frog or a dog, not a butterfly or a fly. We must realize that life is a precious gift. We can choose either to just live and die, or we can find out — why are we here and who is this 'I'? What is the cause of our birth and what happens at death? These are the questions only a human being can ask and answer.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 8: Why Is The Dog Groaning?, Page 20-21

Q: What is the real goal of life according to the book?

A: The Goal of Life is Realization. It starts with Purification and goes to Illumination. Then, of the Truth, when there is Realization, there will be Liberation and Unification. Our goal is to know who we truly are. We are not this body that will one day die. We are the immortal Soul. The purpose of human life is to realize this Truth and attain Liberation from the cycle of birth and death.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: Why do we live and die without discovering our true self?

A: We believe that Spirituality is not for children. Somehow we believe it is only for old people. We have grown up believing in this myth and we will live and die with it. We are not taught the Law of Karma. We are not taught who we truly are. As the poem says: 'We learn so many lessons in life, still we are miserable, full of strife. If we realize the Truth, we can be glad — but we live in ignorance, aren't we mad?'

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 92-93

Q: How does the story of Rajesh show the purpose of life?

A: Rajesh was a smart kid who asked his teacher: 'Are we born just to learn, earn, grow old and die? What is the purpose of this life?' His teacher explained that most people just live and die without

asking these deep questions. But Rajesh kept asking. This curiosity led him to understand the life cycle, Karma, the Soul, and ultimately the deeper truth about existence — showing that asking 'Why am I here?' is the very first step toward discovering life's real purpose.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 1: What Is The Purpose Of Our Life?, Page 6-7

Q: What is the life cycle of a human being as described in the book?

A: The human body is born as a little baby, then it grows up and becomes a child like you. Then it becomes an adult and finally an old man, and then it dies. But the one who lives inside the body — the Soul — never dies. As the grandfather explained to Sam: 'I am the Divine Soul. I am not this body that you see. This body is born as a little baby, then grows up, becomes old and dies. But the Soul lives on.'

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 43: The Life Cycle Of A Baby, Page 90-91

Q: How does the book describe the four quarters of life?

A: Life can be divided into four quarters. The First Quarter is about Learning while the Second is about Earning. The Third and Fourth Quarters are meant for us to attain the ultimate goal of life — Enlightenment. Unfortunately, very few people do. Most of us spend all four quarters learning and earning. We forget that the real purpose of life is Realization — to discover who we truly are.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96

Q: What does it mean to waste our human birth?

A: Life is a precious gift. We can fool people, but we cannot fool Karma. Many of us are like the foolish beggar who threw away the currency notes thinking they were just pieces of paper, while collecting coins. We are blind — we cannot see the big things of life and are just picking the petty coins that attract us. We miss the great opportunity of our human birth to discover the Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 7: The Foolish Blind Beggar, Page 18-19

Q: Why do children need to ask 'Who am I?'

A: We go to school and learn many things, but we still remain a fool because we believe in so many lies. Spirituality makes us use our logic. It helps us overcome ignorance and wipes away the magic. 'Who am I?' and 'Why am I here?' — these are the most important questions. Because if we don't go to the bottom of the root, we do not realize what is the Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: What happened when Peter's mother understood the true purpose of life?

A: When Peter pointed out that everyone must one day die and there must be a greater purpose, his mother had no answer. She knew whatever Peter was saying was right. From that day, she stopped pushing him to be first in class. Instead, she started talking to Peter about the meaning of life. Together, they began a spiritual quest to understand why they were born and what happens after death.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 12: You Must Be A Winner Peter!, Page 28-29

Q: What is the difference between seeking success and seeking the purpose of life?

A: A few of us are running after success and achievement, seeking pleasure and recognition. But the real purpose of life is not to achieve success. It is to Realize the Truth — to discover who we are and why we are here. Success and achievement are things of this world. They will be left behind when we die. The only thing that matters is whether we discovered our true identity — that we are the Soul, the immortal Divine Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 12: You Must Be A Winner Peter!, Page 28-35

Q: How should we live once we know the purpose of life?

A: Once we realize the purpose of life, we must do good Karma. When we do good deeds, we are blessed. But if we slip, we will be punished by Karma. We must live with awareness that we are not just this body. We are the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life. We must always be grateful to God for this precious human birth and use it wisely to realize the Truth before we die.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 38: Who Gives Us Birth?, Page 80-81

TOPIC: GOD

Q: Who is the real God?

A: God is not 'he' or 'she'. God is a Power in you and me. God has no name or form and God does not live in any heaven in the sky. God is everywhere. God is birthless and deathless. We believe in many Gods because we have created so many names and forms but in reality, God is one. It doesn't matter whether you call God by the name of Jesus, Krishna, Shiva or Allah — all these are names of the one Supreme Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 27: Who Is The Real God?, Page 58-59

Q: Is God a person or a power?

A: God is a Power, not a person. Just as electricity is a power that gives light to the bulb, to the fan and to the TV, there is a Power that gives energy to you and me to live, breathe, walk, talk, sing and do anything. That Power is the Power of God. You cannot see electricity but you know the Power exists. In the same way, you cannot see God as a person, but the Power of God is in everything and everyone.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 32: God Is A Power, Page 68-69

Q: Where is God?

A: God does not live in a heaven up in the sky. God is everywhere. God is a Power that is in you and me. God is a Power that is in every molecule of matter, be it animate or inanimate. Everything is God. As long as there is God's life Power, there is beauty. The moment the life Power leaves, the beauty disappears. That is why a living bird is beautiful but a dead pigeon is not — because the life Power of God has left it.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 34: Where Does All The Beauty Come From?, Page 72-73

Q: Does God have a birthday?

A: God does not have a birthday. God is birthless and deathless. We celebrate so many gods' birthdays because we believe God is a person. But in reality, God is a Power — the Supreme Immortal Power. Power does not have a birthday. Power does not die. When we celebrate God's birthday, we are worshipping the name and form we have given to God, not God in Truth. The Truth is that God was never born and will never die.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 21: When Is God's Birthday?, Page 46-47

Q: Why are there so many different Gods?

A: The story of the blind men and the elephant explains this beautifully. Each blind man felt a different part of the elephant and described it differently. Similarly, we all experience God in a different way and call God by different names. But there is only one God, not many Gods. It doesn't matter whether we call the Supreme Power Jesus, Krishna, Shiva or Allah — all these names point to the same one God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 10: The Blind Men And Their Elephant, Page 24-25

Q: How can God be inside us?

A: Just as the waves come from the ocean and go back to the ocean, we come from God and go back to God. Just as one sun reflects in ten pots of water as ten suns, the one God reflects in each of us. God is the Power inside every living being. As the monk explained to Mary: 'The Lord is in each of these birds. They look like birds but inside them, there is God.' In the same way, God is inside every human being.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 40: How Can God Be Inside Us?, Page 84-85

Q: What is the meaning of God is SIP?

A: God is SIP — the Supreme Immortal Power. We human beings live and die but we don't realize that we are not the body that will die. We are immortal Souls that leave the body at death. The Power inside you and me that keeps us alive — that Power is God. When we die, that Power or the Soul leaves the body. God is Supreme, Immortal, without birth and death. There is no God beyond God. That's why we say God is SIP, the Supreme Immortal Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 36: Who Is God, In Reality?, Page 76-77

Q: Why can't we see God?

A: We cannot see God just as we cannot see electricity. You cannot put your hand inside a socket and feel the electricity but you know the Power exists. It gives light to the bulb, to the fan and to the TV. Similarly, we cannot see God directly, but we can experience God's Power in everything around us — in the sun that shines, in the beauty of flowers, in the breath we breathe. God is not

visible to the eye but is felt by the heart.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 32: God Is A Power, Page 68-69

Q: What is the connection between God and beauty?

A: All beauty comes from God. Everything is beautiful because of God's life Power. The tree with lovely flowers, the pretty bird, the beautiful sunset sky — all of this beauty comes from the Power of God within them. The moment the life Power leaves, the beauty disappears. A dry leaf has no beauty. A dead pigeon has no beauty. God is the source of all beauty in this world.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 34: Where Does All The Beauty Come From?, Page 72-73

Q: Is God in nature and animals too?

A: Yes, God is in everything. God is a Power that is in every molecule of matter, be it animate or inanimate. As the monk explained to Mary at his farm: 'The Lord is in each of these birds. They look like birds but inside them, there is God.' When Mary held a small baby rabbit, she could feel the life Power within it. That Power is God. Even the trees, the rivers, the stones — God is present as the Power in everything.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 35: Where Is Heaven?, Page 74-75

Q: What is the difference between the tree and the flower as it relates to God?

A: A tree appears in many forms — as leaves, flowers, fruits, branches and trunk. But everything comes from one seed and is connected through one life. Similarly, this entire creation appears as many different things but everything comes from one God. Just as the tree dies and everything in it dies, God is the one life that is in all of creation. The flower and the tree are different but they are one life — just as we and God are one.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 37: Is The Tree Different From The Flower?, Page 78-79

Q: Why is God described as birthless and deathless?

A: God is birthless and deathless because God is the Supreme Immortal Power. Power has no birth. Power has no death. It simply exists. We human beings are born and we die, but the Power that gives us life — God — is eternal. Even when our body dies and returns to dust, the Power or Soul that gave us life doesn't die. It simply moves on. This is why God is beyond birth and death.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 39: God Is Immortal, Page 82-83

Q: What did the sugar candy story teach us about God?

A: Mary wanted only the Santa Claus candy and was crying because all the other shapes were available but not Santa. Her mother explained: 'Rudolf and Snowman are made of the same sugar as Santa.' Just like all the candy shapes are made of the same sugar, all Gods — Jesus, Krishna, Shiva, Ganesha — are made of the same divine Power. The name and form are different but the essence is one God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 17: God Is In Everything, Page 38-39

Q: Can we meet God?

A: Mary asked her parents to take her to heaven to meet God for her birthday. But the monk explained to her: 'Mary, God is not what you think. God is not a person sitting in heaven. God is a Power that is in every living being — in you, in me, in the birds, in the animals.' We can experience God not by going to heaven but by looking within ourselves and seeing the Divine Power that gives us life. God is always with us and inside us.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 35: Where Is Heaven?, Page 74-75

Q: How does the human body relate to God?

A: The human body is like a computer. It has hardware — the blood, bones and skin — and software — the mind and intellect. But what is the power supply of this human computer? We don't have a wire that we plug into a socket. The power supply is the Soul, which is part of God. The Soul is what gives energy to the human being to walk and talk, to sing and do anything.

Without God's Power, the body is as lifeless as a computer without electricity.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 18: The Human Computer, Page 40-41

TOPIC: KARMA

Q: What is Karma?

A: The Law of Karma is very powerful. It records every action of ours — good or bad. As you sow, so shall you reap. Just like the seeds that we sow decide the fruits on a tree, the deeds that we do decide our destiny. Every action that we do is recorded by Karma. Therefore, we must only do good deeds because if we do bad deeds, we are sure to suffer, we are sure to cry. Such is the way the Creator has created this world.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 6: As You Sow, So Shall You Reap, Page 22-23

Q: Why do bad things happen to good people?

A: Birth and death are controlled by Karma. All we know is the principle — as you sow, so shall you reap. Just like the seeds that we sow decide the fruits on a tree, the deeds that we do decide our destiny. A child may be born into suffering not because of what they have done in this life, but because of Karma from a past life. This is a difficult truth but it explains why even good people face hardship — it is the Law of Karma at work, not the cruelty of God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 19: Why Do Bad Things Happen To Good People?, Page 42-43

Q: Can we fool Karma?

A: In life, we can fool people. But we cannot fool Karma. The Law of Karma is very powerful. It records every action of ours — good or bad. Rajesh planted trees on three sides of his uncle's farm beautifully but left the fourth side unfinished when his friends called him. When they came back years later, the beautiful row of trees ended as a marsh. He covered his face in shame. We may think we have escaped but our Karma catches up with us always.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 6: As You Sow, So Shall You Reap, Page 22-23

Q: Why was a child born blind?

A: Gurpreet's baby brother was born blind. Rajesh's mother explained: 'When a person dies, only the body dies and the Mind and Ego, ME, leaves along with its Karma. All our good deeds and sins are recorded by Karma. If we have too many sins in our account, then we can be born blind or deaf or dumb or can be born in a poor family.' The Karma performed in a past life determines the conditions of our next birth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 20: Why Was The Little Child Born Blind?, Page 44-45

Q: Why can't mangoes grow on apple trees?

A: Asha wanted mangoes from her garden but there were none. Her mother explained: 'This is because your father did not plant mangoes. As we sow, so shall we reap. If we had planted mango seeds, we would have had mangoes.' This is the Law of Karma. The seed that we plant decides the fruit on the tree. The deeds that we do decide our destiny. We cannot expect a good life if we plant seeds of bad actions.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 28: Why Can't Mangoes Grow On Apple Trees?, Page 60-61

Q: What happens to our Karma when we die?

A: When a person dies, only the body dies. The Mind and Ego, ME, leaves along with its Karma. All our good deeds and sins are recorded by Karma. If our Karma is not settled in this life, we carry it to the next life. Whatever is our Karma — our good or bad deeds — our Mind and Ego carry them to our next life. This is the cycle of birth and death, driven by Karma.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 33: Are Ghosts Real?, Page 70-71

Q: Why did God not decide our birth, gender or family?

A: Asha asked why she was born a girl and not a boy. Her father explained: 'Your mother and I did not decide that you should be a girl. It was your Karma that you were born as our child. Just as the seed that we plant decides the fruit on the tree, the deeds that we do decide our destiny. Everything — when we are born, where we are born, whether we are a boy or a girl — is decided by Karma, not by God's personal preference.'

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 24: Who Controlled My Birth?, Page 52-53

Q: What are the universal laws that God uses to manage the world?

A: This world is managed by God through certain universal laws. There is the Law of Gravity — if you throw a ball up, it automatically comes down. There is the Law of Cycles — the earth completes one rotation exactly in 24 hours. And there is the Law of Karma — as you sow, so shall you reap. God does not interfere in our day-to-day lives. The universe operates through these universal laws automatically.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Introduction, Page 4

Q: How is Karma connected to the story of the robbers?

A: In the story of the greedy robbers, two of them decided to poison the food to kill the other two and take all the jewellery. But while they were gone, the other two had already made a similar plan. All four died. This is the Law of Karma in action. Greed and the desire to harm others led to their own destruction. We cannot escape the consequences of our actions. What we do to others, we ultimately do to ourselves.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What does it mean to do good Karma?

A: We must only do good deeds because if we do bad deeds, we are sure to suffer. When we do good Karma, we are blessed by God. If we slip, we will be punished by Karma. Good Karma means helping others, being kind, being honest and living with love. We must always remember: as you sow, so shall you reap. Every action is recorded. Let us choose our actions wisely because our future — in this life and the next — depends on what we do today.

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 38: Who Gives Us Birth?, Page 80-81

Q: Can we transcend Karma?

A: Yes, we can transcend Karma. Most people are aware of Karma — the universal Law that states, 'What you give is what you get.' But not everybody knows that we can actually transcend Karma, escape from all misery and sorrow, and ultimately attain Liberation or Moksha. When we realize who we truly are — that we are the Soul, not the body or mind — we stop creating new Karma and begin the journey toward Liberation.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96

Q: Is Karma the reason for differences in people's lives?

A: Yes. The reason some are born rich and some poor, some healthy and some sick, some as boys and some as girls — all of this is determined by Karma. The deeds of past lives decide the conditions of the next life. This is not unfair — it is actually the most perfect system of justice. Every soul gets exactly what it has earned through its actions. God does not play favourites. Karma is the great equalizer.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 20: Why Was The Little Child Born Blind?, Page 44-45

Q: How does the Law of Karma apply to seeds and trees?

A: Karma is like the seed we plant. If we plant a mango seed, we get a mango tree. If we plant thorns, we get thorns. The seed we plant decides the fruit on the tree. The deeds we do decide our

destiny. This is the most beautiful illustration of Karma for children — just as every seed gives a specific fruit, every action gives a specific result. We cannot plant bad seeds and expect good fruits. Karma is exact and perfect.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 28: Why Can't Mangoes Grow On Apple Trees?, Page 60-61

Q: What is the Karma of a dying person?

A: Every living creature will die. At the moment of death, the Soul leaves the body and departs. The body, without the life Power, starts to decay and must be destroyed. But the Karma — all the good and bad deeds of the person — does not die with the body. The Mind and Ego carry the Karma forward into the next life. Death is not the end for the Soul; it is only a change of body. And the Karma we carry determines our next journey.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 29: Why Are They Going To Burn Mr Gupta?, Page 62-63

Q: How does the story of Rajesh's trees teach us about Karma in daily life?

A: Rajesh was asked by his uncle to plant a row of trees as a boundary of the entire farm. He did it beautifully on three sides but left the fourth side incomplete when his friends called him away. Years later, when they walked along the boundary, the beautiful row of trees ended abruptly as a marsh. His uncle asked what happened and Rajesh covered his face in shame. In life, we can fool people but we cannot fool Karma. Every incomplete or careless action leaves its mark.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 6: As You Sow, So Shall You Reap, Page 22-23

TOPIC: SOUL

Q: What is the Soul?

A: The Soul is the Spark Of Unique Life. It is the Power inside every living being that gives life to the body. Just as a balloon filled with air bounces and bubbles with life but becomes lifeless once the air is let out, the human body has life because of the Soul. The moment the Soul departs, there is no breath. This is death. The Soul is not visible to the eye but it is the very life force that makes us alive.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 30: Where Does The Soul Go?, Page 64-65

Q: Does the Soul die when the body dies?

A: No, the Soul never dies. The body is born, it grows old and it dies. But the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — never dies. As the grandfather explained to Sam: 'I am the Divine Soul. I am not this body that you see, Sam. This body is born as a little baby, then grows up, becomes old and dies. But the Soul lives on.' The Soul is immortal. Only the body dies. The Soul simply departs from one body and moves on.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 43: The Life Cycle Of A Baby, Page 90-91

Q: Who am I, in reality?

A: You are not your name. You are not this body. You are the Soul — the immortal Spark Of Unique Life. As Sam's teacher told him: 'You are not Sam. Only your name is Sam. This body appears to be you but it is constantly changing. One day, this body will die. But you won't die Sam. You are the Soul that never dies.' In reality, each one of us is a Divine Soul — a part of the Supreme Immortal Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 41: Who Am I, In Reality?, Page 86-87

Q: Where does the Soul go after death?

A: The Soul is a part of God — the Supreme Immortal Power. When the body dies, the Soul departs. It carries with it all the Karma — the good and bad deeds — and moves on to the next life, if the Karma is not fully settled. If we have realized the Truth and transcended Karma, the Soul attains Liberation — Moksha — and merges back into the Supreme Immortal Power. Just like the wave returns to the ocean, the Soul returns to God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 30: Where Does The Soul Go?, Page 64-65

Q: What is the difference between the Soul and the body?

A: The body is the hardware — the blood, bones and skin. The Soul is the power supply. Just as a computer has hardware and software and needs electricity to work, the human body needs the Soul to work. Without the Soul, the body is lifeless. The body is temporary — it ages, gets sick and dies. But the Soul is eternal — it never ages, never gets sick and never dies. The body is what we

appear to be; the Soul is what we truly are.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 18: The Human Computer, Page 40-41

Q: Am I the Soul?

A: Yes, you are the Soul. Sam went to his teacher after his conversation with his grandfather and the teacher confirmed: 'Only your name is Sam. You are not this boy that is in the photograph. You are the Soul.' This is the greatest Truth in spirituality — we are not the body, we are not the mind, we are the Soul. The body is a temporary vehicle. The Soul is the eternal passenger riding in it.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 42: Am I The Soul?, Page 88-89

Q: What is the connection between the Soul and God?

A: The Soul is a part of God — the Supreme Immortal Power. Just as the wave is a part of the ocean, the Soul is a part of God. God is the Power inside you and me. When we die, that Power or the Soul leaves the body. We think it is the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — but in reality, the Power inside you and me is God. We are not separate from God. We are Divine Souls, sparks of the Supreme Immortal Power.

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 36: Who Is God, In Reality?, Page 76-77

Q: What is a ghost, really?

A: The concept of ghosts is a myth, a fairy tale. It is not true. At death, the Soul departs. The Soul is a Spark Of Unique Life. We are all energized by the Divine Power. In fact, we all are the Power. When we die, the Soul leaves the body with its Karma. There are no ghosts hovering around. Don't believe in ghosts, because they don't exist. What people call a ghost is simply the fear of the unknown — a False Expectation Appearing Real.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 33: Are Ghosts Real?, Page 70-71

Q: Can we see the Soul?

A: We cannot see the Soul just as we cannot see electricity or air. But we know that the Soul exists because without it, the body is lifeless. When Gurpreet's father let the air out of two balloons, he asked Gurpreet: 'What happened to the balloons?' Gurpreet said they became lifeless. The father explained: 'The human body has life because of the Soul. The moment the Soul departs, there is no breath. This is death.' The Soul is invisible but its presence is known by the life it gives.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 30: Where Does The Soul Go?, Page 64-65

Q: Why should we not fear death if we are the Soul?

A: If we truly understand that we are the Soul and not the body, then we have no reason to fear death. The body will die but the Soul never dies. Death is not the end — it is a bend to transcend. The body dies but the Soul lives on, moving to the next life or attaining Liberation. When we overcome the fear of death, we start to truly live. We can live with freedom, peace and joy, knowing that our true self is immortal.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: What happens to our identity when the body changes?

A: The grandfather showed Sam a photo of himself as a baby. Sam laughed and said: 'How can this be you, dada? This is just a baby boy.' The grandfather explained: 'One day you will also become old, like me.' The body keeps changing from a baby to a child to an adult to an old man. But who stays the same? The Soul. Our real identity is not this changing body but the unchanging Soul within. The body is constantly changing; the Soul is eternal.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 43: The Life Cycle Of A Baby, Page 90-91

Q: What does SOUL stand for?

A: SOUL stands for Spark Of Unique Life. Each one of us is a unique Spark of the Divine. We are the Soul, the Spark Of Unique Life. We come from God and we return to God. The body is born from Karma and dies because of Karma, but the Soul — that Spark of Unique Life — is the real us. It is divine, immortal and a part of the Supreme Immortal Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 33: Are Ghosts Real?, Page 70-71

Q: How can children understand the Soul through the balloon example?

A: Gurpreet's father got two balloons — one blue and one white. He blew air into them and they bounced and bubbled with life. He asked Gurpreet: 'How come these dead rubber balloons are now bouncing with life?' Gurpreet said: 'Because they have air in them.' The father explained: 'The human body has life because of the Soul. The moment the Soul departs, there is no breath. This is death.' He let the air out and the balloons went flat. This is what happens when the Soul leaves the body.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 30: Where Does The Soul Go?, Page 64-65

Q: What is the relationship between the Soul and rebirth?

A: When a person dies, only the body dies. The Mind and Ego, ME, leaves along with its Karma. All our good deeds and sins are recorded. If our Karma is not settled in this life, we are reborn. We can be born as a human or as an animal depending on our Karma. This is the cycle of birth and death. The Soul takes on a new body again and again until all Karma is settled and Liberation — Moksha — is attained.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 20: Why Was The Little Child Born Blind?, Page 44-45

Q: How does the ocean and wave example explain the Soul?

A: The teacher asked Seema: 'Do you know where the waves come from?' Seema replied: 'Of course, they come from the ocean.' 'And where do the waves go?' 'They go back into the ocean.' Just as the wave comes from the ocean, plays on the surface for a while and then goes back into the ocean, we — as Souls — come from God, live in a body for a while and then go back to God. The wave was never separate from the ocean, and we are never truly separate from God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 40: How Can God Be Inside Us?, Page 84-85

TOPIC 5: FEAR

Q: What is fear?

A: FEAR is a False Expectation Appearing Real. It is not a real thing — it is something our mind creates based on imaginary future problems. Ramesh was always afraid — afraid of COVID, afraid of death. But his father explained: 'Son, the fear you feel is not based on what is happening now. It is based on what you imagine might happen. And most of what we imagine never happens. Fear is only a False Expectation Appearing Real.'

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: Why do we feel fear?

A: We feel fear because our mind jumps to the future and creates worry, stress and anxiety. The mind goes to tomorrow and creates fear about what might happen. But most of what we fear never actually occurs. Fear is the mind's way of trapping us. When the mind appears, it brings with it fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame and guilt. This is why the mind is called a rascal — it steals our peace and replaces it with fear.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: How can we overcome fear?

A: We can overcome fear by having faith and by facing the things we are afraid of. As the story of the bulldog shows: when Ramesh's father's friend had no fear of the dog that chased him, he turned around, and the dog ran away. Fear gives power to what we are afraid of. Courage takes that power away. When we have faith — faith in God, faith in ourselves — fear cannot survive. Faith and fear cannot coexist.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: Is the fear of death real?

A: The fear of death stops us from living life. While we are all alive, we are paralyzed by this fear. But fear of death is also a False Expectation Appearing Real. If we truly understand that we are the Soul and not the body, we will no longer fear death. The body dies but the Soul never dies. When we overcome the fear of death, we start to truly live. We can live with freedom, peace and joy.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: What is the connection between fear and the mind?

A: Fear is created by the mind. The mind is a rascal — a thief. When the mind appears, it brings with it fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame and guilt. This aggression of toxic thoughts leads us into depression. The mind jumps to tomorrow and creates stress, worry and anxiety. Without the mind, there would be no fear. The key to overcoming fear is to still the mind. When the mind is still, peace is found and fear disappears.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: What does the story of the bulldog teach about fear?

A: Ramesh's father narrated the story of his friend who was chased every day by a fierce bulldog when he got off the bus. One day, the friend carried metal rods in his bag. The bulldog chased him as usual. But that day, the man had no fear. So, he turned around and faced the dog. The dog ran away and never chased him again. This shows that fear gives power to what we are afraid of. When we face our fears with courage, they lose their power over us.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: What is the relationship between fear and faith?

A: Fear and faith are opposites. When we have fear, we have no faith. When we have faith, we have no fear. Ramesh wore double and triple masks because of his fear. His father, who had faith, wore a mask only when required by law and had no fear. Faith in God, faith in the universal laws, and faith in the Soul's immortality — this is what replaces fear with peace and courage.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: How does COVID show us the nature of fear?

A: Ramesh was always afraid of COVID. He wore double and triple masks because of his fear. But his father explained that fear is only a False Expectation Appearing Real. His father had already been infected with COVID twice and had recovered. He had no fear. Fear does not protect us — it paralyzes us. What protects us is awareness, care and faith, not fear. Fear only creates stress and takes away our peace.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: Why do children feel fear?

A: Children feel fear when they imagine bad things happening to them. This imagination is the mind at work — creating fear out of nothing. The mind creates pictures of what might go wrong and makes those pictures feel very real. This is why FEAR is called a False Expectation Appearing Real. Most of what we fear never actually happens. The solution is to stay in the Present moment and not let the mind run into the future.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: Is Ramesh's fear of death common?

A: Yes, fear of death is one of the most common fears that human beings have. Ramesh lived in fear of COVID and fear of death. But this fear is based on not knowing the Truth. If we know that we are the Soul and not the body, and that the Soul never dies, then the fear of death disappears. Death is not the end — it is a bend to transcend. The body will die, but the one who lives in the body never dies.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: What are some common fears that the book mentions?

A: The book mentions several common fears: fear of COVID and disease, fear of death, fear of the future, fear of bad luck (like black cats), fear of ghosts, and fear of the unknown. All of these fears are False Expectations Appearing Real. None of them are truly real. They are all created by the mind. When we understand that God's laws govern everything perfectly, and that Karma determines our destiny, we have no reason to be afraid.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapters 3, 23, 33, Page 10, 50, 70

Q: What is the danger of living in fear?

A: Living in fear means we never truly live. The fear of death stops us from living life. We are paralyzed, always protecting ourselves, always worrying about what might happen. We lose our peace of mind and happiness. Fear also makes us believe in superstitions and myths — like the black cat bringing bad luck or ghosts hovering after death. Fear keeps us ignorant and prevents us

from discovering the Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: How is Ramesh different from his father when it comes to fear?

A: Ramesh always lacked courage and confidence because of fear. He wore double and triple masks even when they weren't required. His father, on the other hand, was very bold. He wore a mask when the law directed him to but had no unnecessary fear. The father had been infected with COVID twice and had recovered. His experience gave him wisdom and faith that replaced fear. The difference between Ramesh and his father was knowledge and faith.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 3: Fear Is A False Expectation Appearing Real, Page 10-11

Q: What is the superstition of the black cat, and why is it fear-based?

A: Shyam and his mother were about to cross a road when a black cat ran across their path. His mother pulled his arm and said: 'Wait! This is a bad omen. If we cross the path that the black cat took, something really bad will befall us.' Shyam could not understand what connection a black cat had with his luck. This superstition is a form of fear — a False Expectation Appearing Real. There is no logical connection between a black cat and bad luck.

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 23: A Black Cat Just Crossed My Path, Page 50-51

Q: How can spirituality help us overcome fear?

A: Spirituality teaches us the Truth. When we know the Truth — that we are the Soul and not the body, that God's universal laws govern everything, that Karma determines our destiny, that death is not the end — we have no reason to fear. Spirituality replaces fear with faith, ignorance with wisdom, and anxiety with peace. It is the best tool to overcome any and all kinds of fear in life.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

TOPIC 6: LOVE

Q: What is love?

A: True love is not just romance between a boy and a girl. The world doesn't understand the real meaning of love. True love is like a rainbow with seven colours. Violet Love is between a child and parents. Indigo Love is between friends. Blue Love is between a boy and a girl. Green Love is when you love yourself. Yellow Love is more when two people talk intellectually. Orange Love is emotional, mostly in women. And the seventh colour, Red Love, is Divine Love — the purest love of all.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Is love bad?

A: Asha was disturbed after watching a series on television where a man cheated on his wife and the wife cried with a broken heart. She asked her father: 'Why did God create love? Love makes people cry. Is love so bad, papa?' Her father explained: 'Do you love me? Does your mom love you? Do I love God? Is that bad?' No, love is not bad. Love is beautiful. It is the wrong understanding of love that causes pain, not love itself.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: How many types of love are there?

A: According to the book, love has seven colours like a rainbow — VIBGYOR. Violet: love between child and parents. Indigo: love between friends. Blue: love between a boy and a girl. Green: love for oneself. Yellow: intellectual love between people who connect through ideas. Orange: emotional love. Red: Divine Love from the Soul, the purest and highest form of love. True love is not just one colour — it is all seven together, with Red Divine Love as the foundation.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: What is Divine Love?

A: Divine Love is the purest and highest form of love. It is White Divine Love that comes from the Soul. It is the seventh colour in the rainbow of love — Red Love. True love from the Soul manifests as the seven colours of human love from the day we are born till the day we die. Divine Love is unconditional. It does not expect anything in return. It is the love that God has for all of creation. When we love everyone and everything with this Divine Love, we are truly living.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Why does love sometimes cause pain?

A: Love causes pain when it is not true love but attachment, expectation or possessiveness. When a man cheats on his wife, it is not true love that caused the pain — it is the absence of true love. True love is selfless. It does not cheat, it does not hurt, it does not abandon. When people confuse love with desire and attachment, they suffer. But true love — Divine Love from the Soul — only brings joy, never pain.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Can a child love God?

A: Yes, absolutely. In fact, the love between a devotee and God is the most beautiful form of love. As Asha's father explained: 'Do you know if I love God? Yes, you have told me many times.' The love for God — Divine Love — is the highest and purest love. When we love God, we love the Supreme Immortal Power within ourselves and within everything around us. This love takes us closest to the Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: What is the love between parents and children?

A: The love between a child and parents is the first and most fundamental type of love. In the rainbow of love, it is represented by Violet Love. It is one of the most natural and beautiful forms of love. This is why a grandfather is a child's best friend, why a mother's love is unconditional and why children feel safest with their parents. This love teaches us what true selfless love feels like.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: How does love connect us to God?

A: God is love and love is God. When we experience true love — whether for our parents, our friends or for God — we are experiencing a spark of the Divine. The more we love, the closer we come to God. God created this world out of love. Everything in creation is a manifestation of God's love. When we love others selflessly and with kindness, we are acting like God. Love is the bridge between us and the Divine.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Is it okay for a boy and a girl to love each other?

A: Yes, the love between a boy and a girl is one of the seven colours of love. It is represented by Blue Love. It is a natural and beautiful part of human experience. The problem is not love itself — it is when love is mixed with selfishness, possessiveness or deception. True love between a boy and a girl is based on respect, care and commitment. When it is pure, it brings great happiness to both.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: What is self-love?

A: Self-love is represented by Green Love in the rainbow of love. It means loving and respecting yourself. Many people confuse self-love with selfishness, but they are very different. Self-love means caring for yourself — your body, your mind and your Soul. When you love yourself, you are acknowledging the Divine within you. You cannot truly love others if you do not first love yourself.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Why did God create love?

A: God created love because love is the very nature of God. God is love. Without love, there would be no creation. Love is what holds this world together. From the love between parents and children to the love between friends, from love for nature to love for God — all of it comes from the same source. God created love so that we could experience the Divine in each other and ultimately find our way back to God through love.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: What is the difference between true love and attachment?

A: True love is selfless, unconditional and never causes harm. Attachment, on the other hand, is based on expectation and possession. When we are attached, we get hurt when things don't go our way. When we truly love, we want the best for the other person without expecting anything in return. The man who cheated on his wife in the television series that disturbed Asha was not acting from true love but from selfish attachment.

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: Can we love all people equally?

A: True spirituality asks us to see God in everyone and love all beings equally. When we realize that God is in every human being, in every animal, in every living thing, then we begin to love all of them as God. This is the highest form of love — Divine Love that sees no difference between people. We love all as our own family because at the deepest level, we are all one — all part of the same Supreme Immortal Power.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

Q: How does love relate to happiness?

A: Love is one of the greatest sources of true happiness. When we love and are loved, we experience joy that goes beyond pleasure. The love between Raju and his grandfather, the love between Sam and his grandfather, the love between children and their teachers — all of these relationships brought happiness. True love — Divine Love — is the foundation of Eternal Bliss. When we live with love, we live with happiness.

source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 4: Life Is A Gift, Page 12-13

Q: What is the highest expression of love?

A: The highest expression of love is Divine Love — Red Love in the rainbow of love. It is the love that comes from the Soul, which is a part of God. This love is unconditional, selfless and all-encompassing. It is the love of the monk who explains God to Mary. It is the love of the teacher who guides Seema. It is the love of the grandfather who patiently answers Sam's questions. When we love in this way, we are closest to God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 26: Isn't Love Bad?, Page 56-57

TOPIC: GREED AND SUPERSTITION

Q: What is greed and why is it harmful?

A: Greed is the desire for more than what we need. Every human being seems to be greedy. But greed destroys us. In the story of the four robbers, two decided to poison the food of the other two to take all the jewellery. But the other two had the same plan. All four died. Greed did not give them more — it took away everything including their lives. This is what greed does — it promises more but destroys all.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What does the story of the robbers teach us about greed?

A: The four robbers had stolen a lot of jewellery. Instead of being satisfied, two of them decided to poison the other two to get all the jewellery. But the other two had already made the same plan. They poisoned each other's food. All four died. None of them enjoyed the jewellery. This is the lesson: when we become greedy, we lose everything. Greed is never satisfied. The more you give it, the more it wants. And in the end, it destroys the greedy person.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What is spirituality's solution to greed?

A: Spirituality is all about good living. It is about having faith in God and differentiating between good and bad, right and wrong and doing good things. The solution to greed is contentment — being happy with what we have. When we are content, we don't need to cheat, steal or harm others to get more. Spirituality teaches us that we came with nothing and we will go with nothing. We must give before we are gone.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What is the superstition of the black cat?

A: Shyam's mother believed that if a black cat crosses your path, it is a bad omen and will bring bad luck. When a black cat ran across their path, she pulled Shyam's arm and stopped him from walking. Shyam could not understand what connection a black cat had with his luck. This is pure superstition — a belief that has no logical or spiritual basis. There is no law in creation that says a black cat

brings bad luck.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 23: A Black Cat Just Crossed My Path, Page 50-51

Q: What is a dogma or superstition, and why do people believe in them?

A: Shyam grew up in a house that believed in too many rituals, dogmas and superstitions. His father changed all the doors of the house because a scholar told him it would improve their luck. Shyam could not understand how changing the position of doors could change the luck of a family. People believe in dogmas and superstitions because they are afraid and don't know the Truth. They look for external solutions to what are actually internal problems.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 23: A Black Cat Just Crossed My Path, Page 50-51

Q: What does the book say about Vaastu and luck?

A: Shyam's father was told by a scholar that the doors in their house were causing bad luck and needed to be changed as per Vaastu. Shyam could not understand how one could change the luck of a family by changing the position of the doors. True luck is not determined by the direction of doors or the position of furniture. Our destiny is determined by Karma — by the actions we do. No Vaastu can change bad Karma.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 23: A Black Cat Just Crossed My Path, Page 50-51

Q: Why is the Santa Claus story a myth?

A: Peter grew up believing that Santa Claus brought gifts for him. When he was older, he realized that it was his father who had bought the gifts. He confronted his parents: 'Why have you been fooling me all these years? When there is no Santa Claus, why do you make us believe in a lie?' The Santa Claus story, like many myths, is told with good intention but it teaches children to believe in things that are not real.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 14: The Myth Of Santa Claus, Page 32-33

Q: What is the myth of heaven and hell?

A: Raj was told to take biryani to the priest so that his grandfather in heaven would get butter chicken. He asked the old wise man how this magic was possible. The man explained: 'There is no magic trick involved. Unfortunately, we believe in the myth and don't realize the truth. Heaven and hell are not located somewhere else; they are right here on earth.' Heaven and hell are states of mind that we experience here, not physical places we go to after death.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 15: Where Is Grandpa, Mom?, Page 34-35

Q: Why do people pray for ancestors in heaven?

A: Gurpreet asked his father why they put garlands on his grandmother's photograph and lit incense sticks. His father said it was to pray for her well-being in heaven. But Gurpreet pointed out: 'How is grandma in heaven when you burnt her body yourself?' People pray for ancestors out of love and respect. But the belief that the dead person is in heaven eating the food offered is a myth. The Soul moves on; it does not need offerings of food.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 16: Why Pray For Our Ancestors?, Page 36-37

Q: What is the danger of believing in myths and superstitions?

A: Myths and superstitions keep us in ignorance. They prevent us from discovering the Truth. When we believe in black cats, Vaastu, Santa Claus, ghosts and food offerings for ancestors, we are living in a world of illusion. Spirituality is a science. It makes us use our logic. It helps us overcome ignorance and wipes away the magic. When we overcome myths and superstitions, we can begin the journey toward the real Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: How does greed relate to Karma?

A: Greed is a form of bad Karma. When we are greedy, we try to take more than what is ours and this harms others. The Law of Karma records this and brings it back to us. The greedy robbers who poisoned each other all died. Their greed created Karma that destroyed them. The Law of Karma ensures that we receive exactly what we give. If we give greed and harm, we receive harm in return.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What is the difference between needs and greed?

A: We all have needs — food, shelter, clothing, love. These are legitimate and must be fulfilled. But

greed is wanting more than what we need. The fisherman Tom had enough fish to feed his family and was happy. But Robert pushed him to become rich, build a business and buy yachts. Tom wisely asked: 'Why should I become rich? I have enough.' Needs bring contentment; greed brings suffering. The wise person knows the difference.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 9: Robert Told Tom You Can Be Rich!, Page 22-23

Q: What does the book say about rituals?

A: The book does not say that all rituals are bad. But it does say that we must understand what we are doing and why. When Raj was asked to give biryani to the priest for his grandfather in heaven, he questioned the logic of it. A wise man explained that there is no magic by which the priest eating biryani on earth would feed his grandfather in heaven. Rituals can be meaningful when done with understanding but become harmful when they are based on blind belief.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 15: Where Is Grandpa, Mom?, Page 34-35

Q: How is contentment different from greed?

A: Contentment is being happy and peaceful with what we have. Greed is the desire for more and more, never being satisfied. A few of us are happy as we live with contentment and fulfillment. We experience peace. The greedy robbers had stolen jewellery but were not content — they wanted all of it for themselves. Their greed destroyed them. The content person lives in peace; the greedy person lives in agitation and eventually destroys themselves.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 2: Greed Destroys Us, Page 8-9

Q: What lesson do the fisherman Tom and Robert teach children about greed?

A: Robert, a rich businessman, tried to motivate Tom the fisherman to become rich. He described all his possessions — his building, his Mercedes, his yacht. Tom asked: 'Why should I become rich? I have enough.' He was happy playing with his child near his little fishing boat.

Robert's lifestyle required years of stress and hard work. Tom was already living with joy and freedom. The lesson: we don't need more to be happy. Contentment is true wealth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 9: Robert Told Tom You Can Be Rich!, Page 22-23

TOPIC: DEATH AND REBIRTH

Q: What is death?

A: Death is when the Soul leaves the body. Every living creature will die. In the moment of death, we leave the body and depart. The body will start to smell and decay if it is not destroyed, so we have to destroy it through burning or burial. But death is not the end of the Soul. Only the body dies. The Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — continues its journey. Death is not 'The End.' Death is a bend to transcend.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 29: Why Are They Going To Burn Mr Gupta?, Page 62-63

Q: Why are bodies burnt or buried after death?

A: Gurpreet saw that when Mr Gupta died, his body was to be taken to the crematorium and burnt. He asked his father: 'But why?' His father explained: 'Because in the moment of death, we leave the body and depart. The body will start to smell and decay if it is not destroyed.

Hence, we have to destroy it by burning or burial.' The body is like a vehicle. When the Soul leaves, the vehicle is no longer needed and must be returned to the elements.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 29: Why Are They Going To Burn Mr Gupta?, Page 62-63

Q: Why does the butterfly die?

A: Mary and Ram saw a beautiful butterfly drop to the ground and die. Mary could not understand why. Ram explained it had died. Her father tried to make her understand: 'This is how God has made the world.' While it is true that every living creature will die, many of us don't understand why. Not many understand what happens after we die. The butterfly's death, like the death of every living being, is not the end — it is part of the cycle of life.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 13: Why Did The Butterfly Die?, Page 30-31

Q: Is there rebirth after death?

A: Yes. When a person dies, only the body dies. The Mind and Ego, ME, leaves along with its Karma. All our good deeds and sins are recorded. If our Karma is not settled in this life, we are reborn. We can be born blind, deaf or dumb or in a poor family if we have too many sins. This is the cycle of birth and death driven by Karma. We continue to be reborn until all our Karma is resolved and Liberation is attained.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 20: Why Was The Little Child Born Blind?, Page 44-45

Q: Where does grandpa go after death?

A: When Raj asked where grandpa was after death, the wise man explained: 'Heaven and hell are not located somewhere else; they are right here on earth.' When people die, the Soul departs and moves on based on its Karma. The grandfather who was a good person and lived well may attain a better life in the next birth or attain Liberation. The idea that grandpa is sitting in heaven eating the food we offer is a myth, not the Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 15: Where Is Grandpa, Mom?, Page 34-35

Q: Is there life after death?

A: Yes, there is life after death — but it is not the body that continues. The body dies and is destroyed. But the Soul continues its journey. The Soul carries with it all the Karma of this life and moves on to the next. If the Soul has attained Liberation — Moksha — it merges back into the Supreme Immortal Power and there is no more rebirth. Otherwise, it takes on a new body and begins a new life. Life after death is the continuation of the Soul's journey.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 30: Where Does The Soul Go?, Page 64-65

Q: Why do we cry when someone dies?

A: We cry when someone dies because we miss them and because we don't understand death. Mary cried when the butterfly died because she wanted it to fly again. Sam was shocked when he learned that his grandfather would one day die. When we don't know the Truth — that the Soul never dies and that death is only a change of body — we grieve deeply. But when we understand the Truth, we can mourn the loss of the body while knowing that the Soul lives on.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 13: Why Did The Butterfly Die?, Page 30-31

Q: What is Liberation or Moksha?

A: Liberation or Moksha is freedom from the cycle of birth and death. When we realize the Truth — that we are the Soul, that we are a part of God, the Supreme Immortal Power — we transcend Karma. We stop creating new Karma and settle all old Karma. When all Karma is settled and the Truth is fully realized, the Soul attains Liberation and merges back into God. This is the ultimate goal of life — to be free from rebirth and unite with the Divine.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What should we understand about the death of a child?

A: Sam's little sister died. Rajesh cried and asked his mother: 'Why did God take away their little baby? Why did Sam's sister die so early?' His mother explained: 'Birth and death are controlled by Karma. Just like the seeds that we sow decide the fruits on a tree, the deeds that we do decide our destiny.' Even the death of a child is governed by Karma from past lives. It is not God's cruelty. It is the precise working of the Law of Karma.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 19: Why Do Bad Things Happen To Good People?, Page 42-43

Q: Can we go to heaven when we die?

A: Heaven as a physical location in the sky is a myth. The wise old man explained to Raj: 'Heaven and hell are not located somewhere else; they are right here on earth.' We experience heaven when we live with joy, love, peace and contentment. We experience hell when we live in suffering, greed and hatred. The idea that we go to a physical heaven and meet our relatives after death is a belief that brings comfort but is not the ultimate Truth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 15: Where Is Grandpa, Mom?, Page 34-35

Q: What happened to Mr Gupta's soul?

A: Gurpreet saw Mr Gupta's body being prepared for cremation and wondered what happened to his Soul. His father explained: 'Every living creature will die. In the moment of death, we leave the body and depart.' Mr Gupta was a good man and his Karma would determine where his Soul went next. The body returned to the elements through cremation. The Soul departed with all its Karma, continuing its journey toward either rebirth or Liberation.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 29: Why Are They Going To Burn Mr Gupta?, Page 62-63

Q: Why is death not the end?

A: Death is not the end because the Soul never dies. The body is born, grows old and dies. But the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — is immortal. When the body dies, the Soul simply departs and moves on. As the grandfather explained to Sam: 'I am the Divine Soul. This body will die and the game is over but the Soul lives on.' Death is not the end — it is a bend to transcend. It is the end of one body, not the end of the Soul.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 43: The Life Cycle Of A Baby, Page 90-91

Q: What does the body become after death?

A: After death, the body is destroyed — either burned in cremation or buried in the ground. Eventually, the body returns to the elements it was made of. Just like the dry leaf that Seema's mother picked up in the park — it was once a beautiful green leaf full of life, but when the life Power left it, it became dry and withered. The body without the Soul is just matter returning to the earth.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 34: Where Does All The Beauty Come From?, Page 72-73

Q: How can we prepare for death?

A: The best way to prepare for death is to do good Karma in this life. When we do good deeds, our Soul accumulates good Karma that leads us to a better next birth or Liberation. We must also seek Enlightenment — the realization of who we truly are. When we know that we are the Soul and not the body, death holds no terror for us. We can face it with peace and even joy, knowing that our true self never dies.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What is the life cycle of a baby from birth to death?

A: The body is born as a little baby. From a tiny cell, the embryo develops in the mother's womb for nine months. Then the baby arrives in the world. It grows from a baby to a child to a teenager to an adult and finally to an old person. Then the body dies. This is the life cycle of the body. But inside this body lives the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — which was never born and never dies. The body has a life cycle; the Soul does not.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 43: The Life Cycle Of A Baby, Page 90-91

TOPIC 9: MIND AND IGNORANCE**Q: What is the mind?**

A: The mind has no physical existence. You can touch your nose, your eyes and you can pull your ears. But where is your mind? You cannot find it. The mind is just a bundle of thoughts. Unlike the brain, which is a physical organ that you can touch, the mind is not a physical thing. It exists as thought — as a constant stream of ideas, memories, worries and plans. The mind is the thinker inside us but it has no physical form.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: Why is the mind called a rascal?

A: The mind is called a rascal and a thief because when the mind appears, it brings with it fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame and guilt. This aggression of toxic thoughts leads us into depression. The mind goes to the past and creates regret, shame and guilt. Then it jumps to tomorrow and creates stress, worry and anxiety. The mind steals our peace and happiness. It constantly distracts us from what we are doing and pulls us into the past and the future.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: Where is the mind?

A: Shyam asked his family at dinner: 'Where is my mind? You keep telling me that my mind is wandering. For the last few days, I am searching for my mind. Where is my mind? I cannot find it!' His grandpa said it was in his head but Shyam pointed out: 'Grandpa, that's my brain.' His mother explained: 'The mind has no physical existence. Your mind is just a bundle of thoughts.' The mind is not located in the brain or anywhere in the body. It exists as thought alone.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: What is the difference between the brain and the mind?

A: The brain is a physical organ — part of the hardware of the human body. Like the processor of a computer, it processes information. The mind is different — it is more like the software, but even then, the mind is not the intellect or memory. The mind is the stream of thoughts that constantly flows through us. You can touch the brain. You cannot touch the mind. The brain is in the head. The mind is everywhere and nowhere.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: How does the mind destroy our peace?

A: There is a rascal called the mind. When the mind appears, it brings with it fear, worry, stress, anxiety, regret, shame and guilt. The mind goes to the past and creates regret and guilt with thoughts that nurse, curse and rehearse the incidents of the past. We lose our peace. Then the mind jumps to tomorrow and creates stress, worry and anxiety. Any peace that we enjoy ceases immediately because of our own mind.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: What is ignorance?

A: Ignorance is not knowing the Truth. Astha's teacher always told her that we must overcome our ignorance. Many of us are like the foolish beggar who did not realize that the paper notes were valuable currency. He was blind to the truth and threw them away while collecting small coins. This is ignorance — not seeing what is truly valuable. We live in ignorance when we don't know who we are, why we are here and what this world truly is.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 7: The Foolish Blind Beggar, Page 18-19

Q: What is the story of the foolish blind beggar about?

A: There was a beggar who kept a box every day in front of a temple. People put both coins and currency notes in his box. But the beggar only kept the coins and threw away the notes because he thought they were just pieces of paper. One day, a kind man explained: 'Why are you throwing away the notes? They are valuable currency!' The beggar was enlightened and from that day gathered much more money. We are like this beggar — blind to the real treasures of life.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 7: The Foolish Blind Beggar, Page 18-19

Q: What is the human computer?

A: The human body is like a computer. It has hardware — the blood, bones and skin — and software — the mind and intellect. But what is the power supply of the human computer? It is the Soul. The Soul is what gives energy to the human being to walk and talk, to sing and do

Anything. Without the Soul's Power, the body would be as lifeless as a computer without electricity. This is a beautiful way to understand the relationship between body, mind and Soul.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 18: The Human Computer, Page 40-41

Q: How can a child control their wandering mind?

A: Shyam complained: 'My mind gets distracted and I go to play and you are all unhappy with my mind. Please help me fix my mind.' His mother explained: 'The mind has no physical existence. Your mind is just a bundle of thoughts.' To control the mind, we must observe our thoughts without getting lost in them. We must stay in the present moment. When we are fully focused on what we are doing now, the mind cannot wander. This is the practice that leads to peace.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: What is the dog's lesson about suffering from ignorance?

A: One day, Victor went to meet his friend and heard a dog moaning and groaning. His friend said:

'He is just sitting on a nail. That is why he is groaning.' Victor asked why the dog didn't just get up. His friend replied: 'It's not hurting enough for him to move.' Astha made the connection: 'Aren't we all like this groaning dog? We groan and moan through life just because it's not hurting us so much.' We suffer from ignorance but don't do anything about it.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 8: Why Is The Dog Groaning?, Page 20-21

Q: What are the toxic thoughts that the mind creates?

A: The mind creates toxic thoughts that steal our peace. When the mind goes to the past, it creates regret, shame and guilt — thoughts that nurse, curse and rehearse the incidents and wrongs of the past. When the mind goes to the future, it creates stress, worry and anxiety. None of these thoughts are about the present reality. They are all imaginary. This aggression of toxic thoughts leads us into depression and robs us of our peace and happiness.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: How does ignorance relate to superstition?

A: Superstition is a form of ignorance. We believe in black cats bringing bad luck, Vaastu determining our fortune and food offerings reaching our ancestors in heaven — all because we don't know the Truth. Spirituality is a science. It makes us use our logic. It helps us overcome ignorance and wipes away the magic. When we are no longer ignorant, we are no longer superstitious. Knowledge of the Truth replaces all superstitions with wisdom.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: What does the book say about living in the present moment?

A: Life is about 'now', the present moment. The biggest gift that we have is the gift of today. That is why it is called 'The Present'. Unfortunately, we let today slip away. The mind drags us to the past with regret and to the future with worry. But the only real moment is now. When we live fully in the present — aware, grateful, joyful — we experience true happiness. All suffering comes from being in the past or the future; all joy comes from being in the now.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: Why is understanding the mind important for children?

A: Children's minds are very active and easily distracted. Understanding the mind helps children stop blaming themselves for being distracted and instead learn to observe their thoughts. When Shyam's mother explained that the mind is just a bundle of thoughts with no physical existence, Shyam understood why his mind wandered. This understanding is the first step to gaining control of the mind. Children who understand the mind can learn to focus, be peaceful and live with awareness.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 25: Where Is My Mind?, Page 54-55

Q: What is the big fish and small fish story teaching us about the mind?

A: The fisherman kept the small fish and threw back the big ones. Sam thought this was foolish — he could have cut the big fish in two. The teacher explained: 'Yes! Just like many of us. We keep all the small ideas in our head and let go of the big things.' The mind clings to petty thoughts — small worries, small pleasures, small achievements — and misses the big Truth. We need a mind that holds onto what truly matters and lets go of what doesn't.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 5: The Big Fish And The Small Fish, Page 14-15

TOPIC 10: ENLIGHTENMENT AND SPIRITUALITY

Q: What is spirituality?

A: Spirituality is the science of the Spirit. Just like we learn so many sciences in school, it is important for children to learn the science of the Spirit. The Spirit or the Soul — the Spark Of Unique Life — is who we truly are. Spirituality is all about good living. It is about having faith in God and differentiating between good and bad, right and wrong and doing good things. Spirituality is also about discovering the Truth — who we are and why we are here.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Back Cover, Page 124

Q: What is Enlightenment?

A: Enlightenment is the realization of the Truth. It is when we discover who we truly are — not the body, not the mind, but the immortal Soul, a part of the Supreme Immortal Power. The Goal of Life is Realization. It starts with Purification and goes to Illumination. Then, of the Truth, when there is

Realization, there will be Liberation and Unification. Enlightenment is the ultimate freedom — freedom from ignorance, from suffering, from the cycle of birth and death.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: Why is spirituality important for children?

A: Don't we all think that Spirituality is meant only for old people? Somehow we believe that Spirituality is not for children. We have grown up believing in this myth and we will live and die with it. But when children enter their teens, their formative minds start believing in all the lies, like God lives in the skies. Spirituality helps children develop the right foundation of understanding. It teaches them the Truth about God, Karma, the Soul and the purpose of life.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Back Cover, Page 124

Q: What is the relationship between religion and spirituality?

A: Religion is only the first step toward God-Realization. Religion is like a kindergarten, of which spirituality is the university, and together they can lead us to God-Realization. Religion gives us rules, rituals and stories. Spirituality takes us beyond rules to the direct experience of Truth. Religion teaches us to pray to God. Spirituality teaches us to realize God within ourselves. Both are important but spirituality is the deeper and more complete science.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What does the Guru or Wise Master do?

A: A teacher, a Mentor or a Master is a Guru. They take us from 'Gu' to 'Ru'. 'Gu' is darkness and 'Ru' is light. A Wise Master or a Guru makes us overcome our ignorance and realize the Truth. Just as the Wise Master told the trapped bird how to attain freedom by pretending to be dead, a Guru shows us the way to freedom from the cage of ignorance. It was not the bird that was wise — it was the Wise Master who knew the way.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 11: The Bird And The Wise Master, Page 26-27

Q: What is the meaning of Enlightenment for a child?

A: Enlightenment for a child begins with asking the right questions: Who am I? Why am I here? What happens when we die? Where is God? Is love bad? When children ask these questions and seek honest answers, they begin their journey toward Enlightenment. The book itself is a guide for children on this path. Every story, every conversation between children and their parents and teachers is a step toward discovering the Truth and beginning the journey to Enlightenment.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: How does the bird in the cage teach us about spiritual freedom?

A: Once, a bird was very sad and trapped in a cage. It longed for freedom. One day, a Wise Master came and told the bird: 'If you want to attain freedom, follow my advice. Tomorrow morning, when your owner comes to feed you, pretend to be dead.' The bird did as instructed and the owner threw it out of the window. The bird then opened its wings and flew away free. This story shows that a Guru's wisdom can show us the way out of our own cage of ignorance.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Chapter 11: The Bird And The Wise Master, Page 26-27

Q: What are the four stages of Enlightenment?

A: The Goal of Life is Realization. It starts with Purification — cleansing our mind, heart and actions. Then comes Illumination — the mind begins to understand the Truth. Then comes Realization — the direct experience of the Truth that we are the Soul, a part of God. Finally comes Liberation and Unification — freedom from the cycle of birth and death and merging with the Supreme Immortal Power. These four stages form the complete journey of Enlightenment.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: Is spirituality a science?

A: Yes! Spirituality is a science. The poem in the book says: 'Spirituality is a science, it makes us use our logic, it helps us overcome ignorance and wipes away the magic!' Unlike superstition and blind belief, spirituality asks us to question, to reason, to discover the Truth for ourselves. It is not about blindly believing but about directly experiencing. Just as science explains the physical world, spirituality explains the inner world of the Soul and God.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Poem, Page 93

Q: What is the Afterword saying about the author's mission?

A: After writing over 65 books on Spirituality, Life, Death, Happiness, Misery, Mind and Consciousness, AiR realized that there was no good book on Spirituality For Children. Children need the same Spiritual Truths but presented in an easily understandable way with stories and analogies. AiR's mission is to help people — including children — discover the way to Eternal Happiness through Enlightenment. He is on a mission to spread Eternal Happiness through enlightenment.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96

Q: How does the book help children discover their true identity?

A: The book helps children discover their true identity through stories and conversations. Sam discovers he is not his name or his body — he is the Soul. Seema discovers that God is not a person in heaven but a Power within everything. Rajesh discovers that life has a purpose beyond learning and earning. Each story peels away a layer of ignorance and reveals a Truth. Step by step, the book guides children from false beliefs to the realization of who they truly are.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What is the Ladder to Heaven?

A: Most people believe in God and aspire to go to God in heaven one day. But there is a Ladder that can take us to God — not in the sky but within ourselves. We need to ascend the rungs of the Ladder to Heaven step by step. These rungs include Purification of thought and action, Illumination of the mind, Realization of the Truth and finally Liberation and Unification with God. This is the step-by-step way to God-Realization.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What is the connection between happiness and enlightenment?

A: Enlightenment leads to Eternal Happiness. Most people chase happiness through success, wealth and pleasure. But these bring only temporary happiness. True and Eternal Happiness comes from within — from the realization of who we are and our connection to God. When we are Enlightened, we are free from fear, greed, anger and attachment. We live in a state of constant peace and joy. This is why the author says: Happiness is not success — Enlightenment is Success.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97

Q: What does it mean to live as an instrument of God?

A: AiR describes himself as living as an instrument of God, doing His Divine Will. When we are Enlightened, we no longer live for our own desires and ego. We surrender to the Divine Will and become channels through which God works in this world. We act with love, wisdom and service to others. We no longer ask 'What can I get?' but 'How can I serve?' This is the highest way of living — as an instrument of God, dedicated to spreading Eternal Happiness.

Source: Spirituality for Children, About the Author, Page 1-2

Q: What is the ultimate truth that the book wants children to realize?

A: The ultimate Truth is: I am SOUL. SOUL is SIP. I am SIP. SIP is in All. We live in ignorance and don't realize the Truth that we are neither the Body nor the Mind and Ego. In reality, we are the SOUL that is nothing but a part of SIP — the Supreme Immortal Power. When this Truth is realized, we are Enlightened. We know who we are. We know why we are here. We know where we came from and where we will go. This is the ultimate goal of Spirituality.

Source: Spirituality for Children, Afterword, Page 96-97